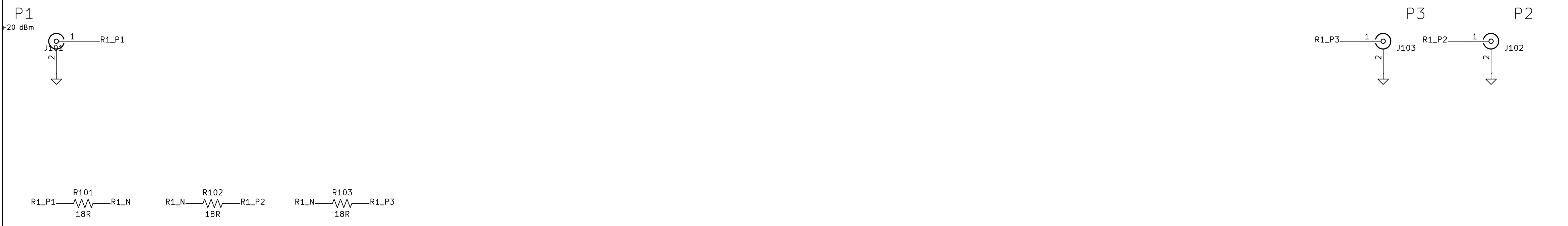
R1 splitter, 3 x 18 ohm, 6 dB

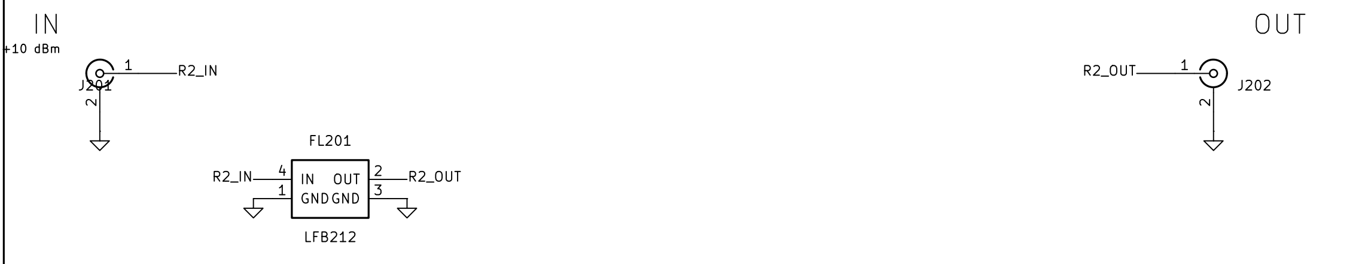
cells (0,0), (1,0)



EXPECT: 6.2 dB from any port to either other port, every port within 2 ohm of 50, DC to 6 GHz (the resistors' parasitics set the top)
Three 18 ohm resistors to one node: the textbook resistive divider, 6 dB per path and no isolation between the two outputs beyond those 6 dB (a Wilkinson would give 3 dB and 20 dB of isolation, at one band). Feed R9's REF OUT to both synthesizers' REF IN, one synthesizer's OUT A to both mixers, or two tones into one gain block.

R2 2.45 GHz filter

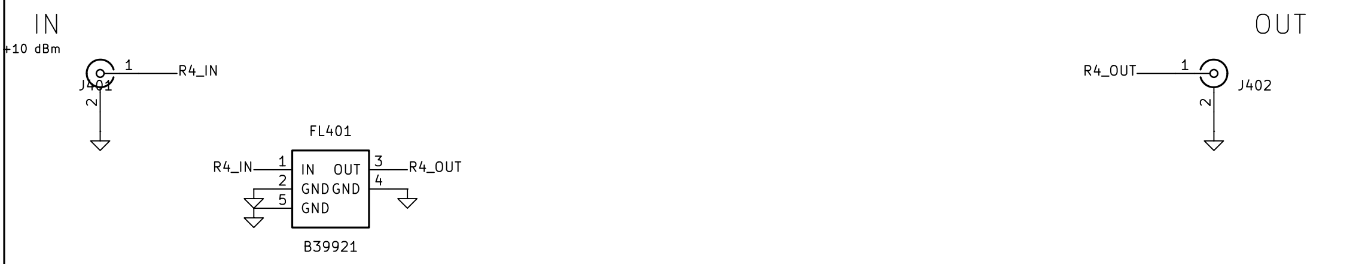
cell (2,0)



EXPECT: 1.7 dB of loss from 2.4 to 2.5 GHz, 30 dB or more below 2.2 GHz and above 2.7 GHz (the datasheet); 50 ohm in and out
Murata LFB212G45SG8A127, a 2012-size LTCC band-pass. The line to each jack is 50 ohm coplanar waveguide (0.29 mm wide, 0.25 to the ground pour) with a via fence; the jack's centre pin has no plane under it (a 2.2 mm void).
Sweep it with the synthesizer R10 or R11 into a power meter, or with a DAC harmonic comb and the ADC.

R4 915 MHz filter

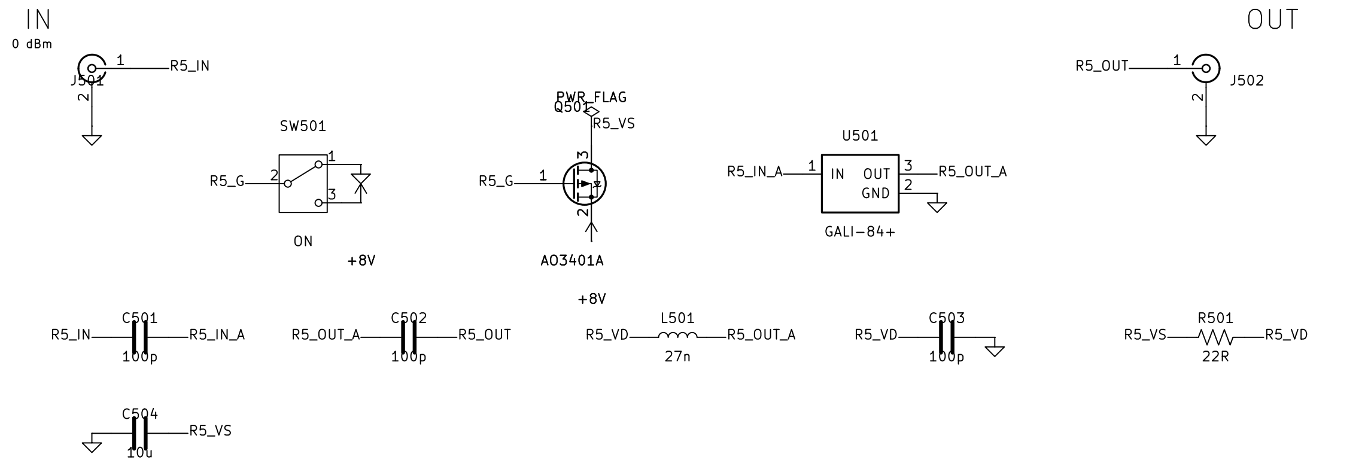
cell (3,0)



EXPECT: 1.1 dB of loss from 902 to 928 MHz, 40 dB or more 30 MHz outside the band (the datasheet); 50 ohm in and out
RF360 B39921B2672P810: a surface-acoustic-wave filter for the 915 MHz ISM band, 26 MHz wide, in a 1411 package; its skirts are much steeper than the LTCC's. Lines, fences and launch voids as on R2.

R5 gain block, GALI-84+

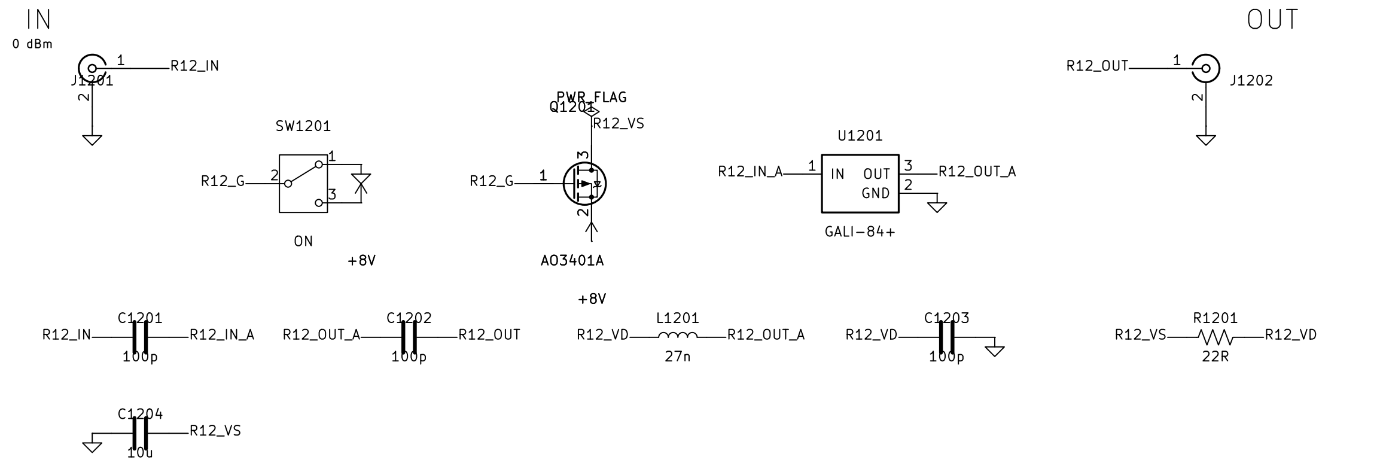
cell (0,1)



EXPECT: 20 dB of gain from 50 MHz to 2.5 GHz (datasheet: 21.9 dB at 1 GHz, 1 dB compression at +20 dBm out); 97 mA from 7.8 V
Mini-Circuits GALI-84+: a Darlington MMIC that sets its own current; the 22 ohm from the 7.8 V rail drops to its 5.8 V device voltage (0.2 W in the 2512). The 27 nH choke (415 ohm at 2.45 GHz, 155 at 915 MHz) feeds the output pin; 100 pF blocks keep the DC off the jacks. Keep the input under 0 dBm for linear gain. The slide switch and P-FET gate the tile's 7.8 V as on AMOD-A.

R12 gain block, GALI-84+

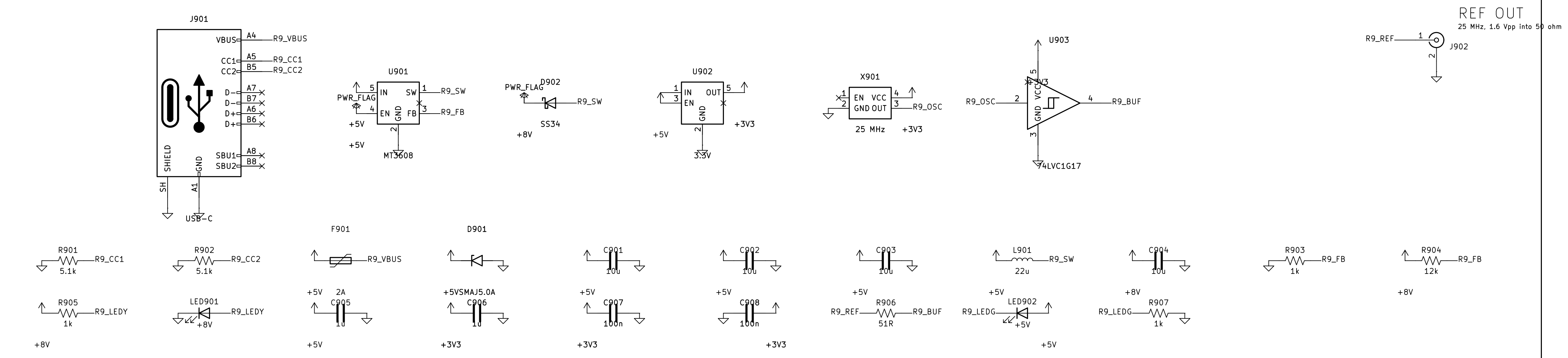
cell (1,1)



EXPECT: 20 dB of gain from 50 MHz to 2.5 GHz (datasheet: 21.9 dB at 1 GHz, 1 dB compression at +20 dBm out); 97 mA from 7.8 V
Mini-Circuits GALI-84+: a Darlington MMIC that sets its own current; the 22 ohm from the 7.8 V rail drops to its 5.8 V device voltage (0.2 W in the 2512). The 27 nH choke (415 ohm at 2.45 GHz, 155 at 915 MHz) feeds the output pin; 100 pF blocks keep the DC off the jacks. Keep the input under 0 dBm for linear gain. The slide switch and P-FET gate the tile's 7.8 V as on AMOD-A.

R9 power, USB-C 5 V in: +5, +7.8 V; 25 MHz reference

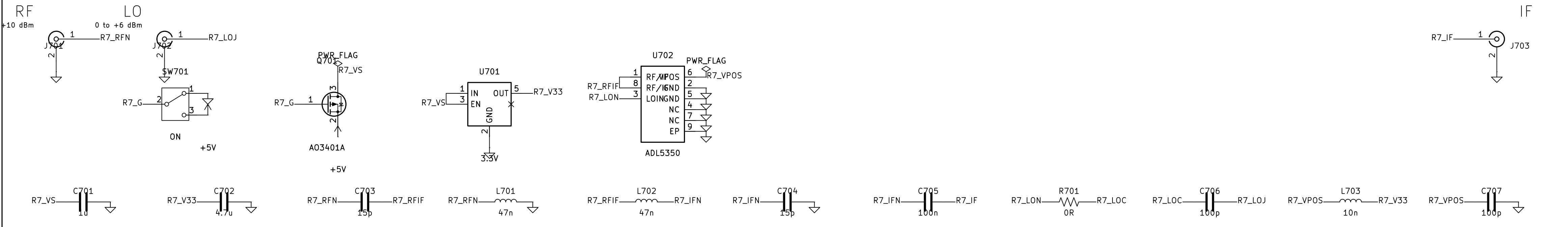
cells (2,1), (3,1)



EXPECT: +5 V from the USB-C (up to 1.5 A), +7.8 V at 250 mA for the gain blocks (yellow LED), a 25 MHz square wave on REF OUT
USB-C power only: 5.1 k on each CC asks any source for 5 V; a 2 A PTC, a 5 V TVS and 20 uF. The MT3608 boosts to 7.8 V (0.6 V x 13 from 12 k / 1 k) for the two GALI-84+ tiles (200 mA); the +8V rail is a strip under row 1 that their headers reach with a via. The TPS7A2033 makes 3.3 V for the TC32H4 TCXO (+-2 ppm) and the 74LVC1G17 that drives REF OUT (51 ohm: 1.6 Vpp into 50 ohm, 3.3 Vpp into a synthesizer's unterminated REF IN; a tee feeds both synthesizers).
The TCXO's pad 1 (enable or no connection on the drawing) floats, as CostasLink's review settled.

R7 TX mixer, ADL5350

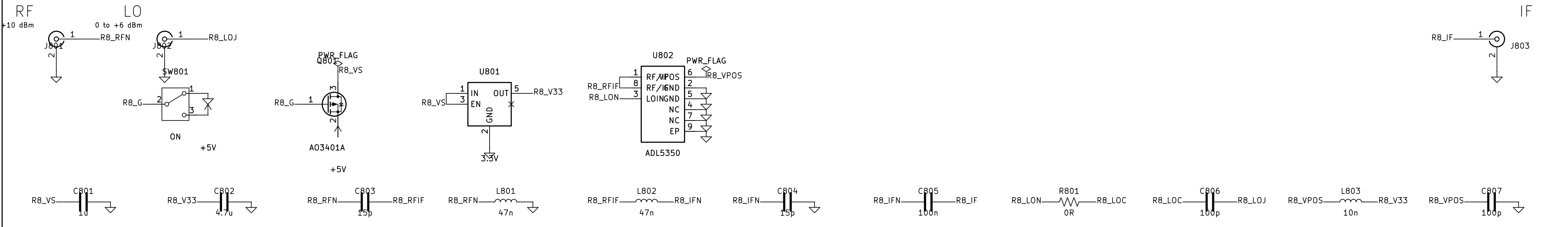
cells (0,2), (1,2)



EXPECT: RF x LO to IF (or IF x LO to RF) with 7-9 dB of loss from 400 MHz to 2.5 GHz and an IF of 0.1-30 MHz; +4 dBm of LO is enough
ADL5350: a GaAs FET switch mixer with its own LO buffer; the RF and IF pins are one node, split by a crossover (series 15 pF + shunt 47 nH toward RF, series 47 nH + shunt 15 pF toward IF, corner 200 MHz) in place of the datasheet's band-tuned tanks: a few dB more loss, every band at once. The LO's series element is 0 ohm (fit the datasheet's 3-8 nH for one band); the LO bias choke is 10 nH (the datasheet: 24 nH at 780 MHz, 2 nH at 2 GHz).
Passive, so the same tile up-converts a DAC tone (IF in, RF out) or down-converts an antenna's signal (RF in, IF out).
Both images appear: filter the RF side with R2 or R4.

R8 RX mixer, ADL5350

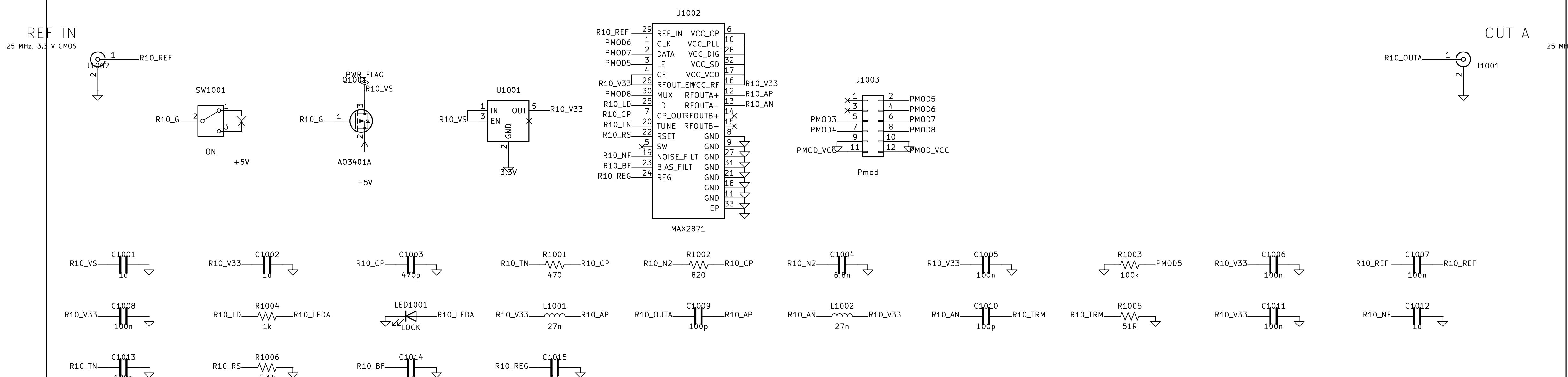
cells (2,2), (3,2)



EXPECT: RF x LO to IF (or IF x LO to RF) with 7-9 dB of loss from 400 MHz to 2.5 GHz and an IF of 0.1-30 MHz; +4 dBm of LO is enough
ADL5350: a GaAs FET switch mixer with its own LO buffer; the RF and IF pins are one node, split by a crossover (series 15 pF + shunt 47 nH toward RF, series 47 nH + shunt 15 pF toward IF, corner 200 MHz) in place of the datasheet's band-tuned tanks: a few dB more loss, every band at once. The LO's series element is 0 ohm (fit the datasheet's 3-8 nH for one band); the LO bias choke is 10 nH (the datasheet: 24 nH at 780 MHz, 2 nH at 2 GHz).
Passive, so the same tile up-converts a DAC tone (IF in, RF out) or down-converts an antenna's signal (RF in, IF out).
Both images appear: filter the RF side with R2 or R4.

R10 synthesizer, MAX2871

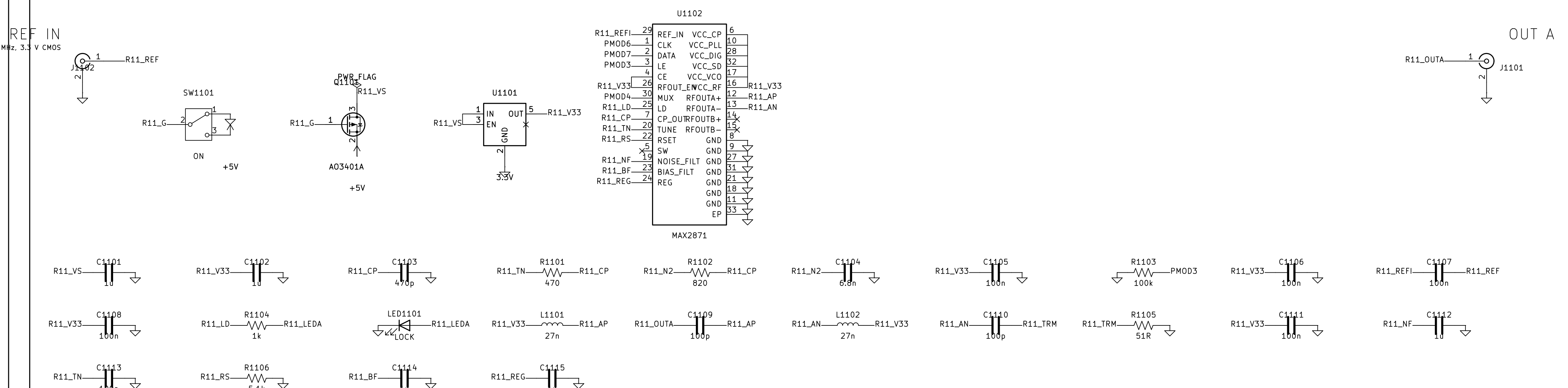
cells (0,3), (1,3)



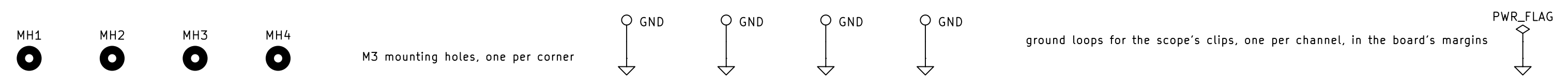
EXPECT: any frequency from 23.5 MHz to 6 GHz on OUT A (−4 to +5 dBm in steps), locked to the 25 MHz on REF IN; the red LED says locked
MAX2871 as CostasLink built it: fractional-N PLL with four VCOs, programmed over SPI from the Pmod (SCLK, SDATA, LE; MUXOUT back). The loop filter is third order, 80-120 kHz with 61 degrees of margin for both 915 MHz (VCO / 4) and 2.4 GHz (VCO / 2) at ICP 2.56 mA (RSET 5.1 k, CP = 7). RFOUTA+ feeds the jack through 27 nH to 3.3 V and 100 pF; RFOUTA− is terminated in 51 ohm the same way; RFOUTB is open and must stay disabled. CE and RFOUT_EN are tied high, LE has 100 k down. REF IN is unterminated: one REF OUT drives both synthesizers through a tee.

R11 synthesizer, MAX2871

cells (2,3), (3,3)



EXPECT: any frequency from 23.5 MHz to 6 GHz on OUT A (−4 to +5 dBm in steps), locked to the 25 MHz on REF IN; the red LED says locked
MAX2871 as CostasLink built it: fractional-N PLL with four VCOs, programmed over SPI from the Pmod (SCLK, SDATA, LE; MUXOUT back). The loop filter is third order, 80-120 kHz with 61 degrees of margin for both 915 MHz (VCO / 4) and 2.4 GHz (VCO / 2) at ICP 2.56 mA (RSET 5.1 k, CP = 7). RFOUTA+ feeds the jack through 27 nH to 3.3 V and 100 pF; RFOUTA− is terminated in 51 ohm the same way; RFOUTB is open and must stay disabled. CE and RFOUT_EN are tied high, LE has 100 k down. REF IN is unterminated: one REF OUT drives both synthesizers through a tee.



M3 mounting holes, one per corner

ground loops for the scope's clips, one per channel, in the board's margins

Drawn by scripts/gen_sch.py from boards/rf_mod.py; the expected responses from sim/passive.py
Every tile is one circuit with its own SMA jacks; the board's silkscreen draws each tile's wires as they
two synthesizers, two mixers, two gain blocks, two filters, a splitter, power and a 25 MHz reference
Board: Jason Gallicchio and Claude | open hardware, CERN-OHL-P-2.0 | github.com/gallicchio/
Sheet: /
File: rf_mod.kicad_sch
Title: RF-MOD: 915 MHz, 2.4 GHz and a stretch to 5.8 GHz
Size: A1 | Date: 2026-10-25 | **Rev: A**
KiCad E.D.A. 10.0.7 | Id: 1/1